

EYEWITNESS May 10, 1863

The Death of Jackson

At the Battle of Chancellorsville, General Stonewall Jackson was accidentally shot by his own troops while reconnoitering in front of his battle line. His left arm was so badly injured that it had to be amputated, but he was thought to be recovering when he contracted pneumonia. He died eight days later on May 10, much to the grief and dismay of his soldiers and fellow Confederate leaders.

“His mind now began to fail and wander, and he frequently talked as if in command upon the field, giving orders in his old way; then the scene shifted and he was at the mess-table, in conversation with members of his staff; now with his wife and child; now at prayers with his military family. Occasional intervals of return of his mind would appear, and during one of them I offered him some brandy and water, but he declined it, saying, ‘It will only delay my departure, and do no good; I want to preserve my mind, if possible, to the last ...’

A few moments before he died he cried out in his delirium, ‘Order A. P. Hill to prepare for action! Pass the infantry to the front rapidly! Tell Major Hawks,’ then stopped, leaving the sentence unfinished. Presently a smile of ineffable sweetness spread itself over his pale face, and he cried quietly and with an expression as if of relief, ‘Let us cross over the river and rest under the shade of the trees’; and then, without pain or the least struggle, his spirit passed from earth to the God who gave it.”

DR. HUNTER MCGUIRE, MEDICAL DIRECTOR OF JACKSON’S CORPS, FROM THE SOUTHERN HISTORICAL SOCIETY PAPERS, RICHMOND, 1886

“The intelligence of the death of Gen. Jackson came upon us like a shock. We feel that his death is a national calamity. The poorest soldiers among us appreciated his worth—loved the man, and mourn his loss ... Among the many heroes of this revolution, none have lived so much adored, none have died so much deplored, and none have left a character as spotless as that of